Toolshed Hire

Tool and Equipment Rental, Cape Town



Task 3: User Guide

Team N/A | Tforce

Student number	Name	Responsibility
ST10434209	Teon Kleynhans	Every role: requirements, architecture, development, testing, deployment, documentation and presentation

Links

Source code https://github.com/teon-artilionAI/toolshed-hire
Live system https://toolshed-hire.vercel.app

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1. About this guide

Toolshed Hire is a tool and equipment hire system for three branches in Cape Town. The branches are Cape Town CBD, Bellville and Somerset West. This guide is for the people who use the system. It is not a technical design document.

The guide has four parts. The first part explains what you need before you start and how an account works. The second part is for customers. The third part is for counter staff. The fourth part is for the owner. The guide ends with the messages you may meet, answers to common problems, a glossary and one page for a technical reader.

Every procedure is written as numbered steps. The expected result follows the action where it matters. Screenshots show the built system, not a design mock-up. Screen identifiers such as SC-04 are the same identifiers used in the final report, so a screenshot in this guide can be matched to the report.

The live site is <https://toolshed-hire.vercel.app>. The source code is at <https://github.com/teon-artilionAI/toolshed-hire>.

Toolshed Hire is a fictional business built for the INSY7315 Work Integrated Learning module. The fleet, the customers and the prices are demonstration data. Do not enter a real identity number, a real card number or any other sensitive personal information into the demonstration site.

2. Before you start

2.1 What you need

You need a modern browser and an internet connection. The system is a web application, so it runs in the browser on a laptop, a tablet or a phone. It does not need an application from an app store.

The supported browsers are the current versions of Chrome, Edge, Firefox and Safari. The customer screens are designed for a desktop width of about 1440 pixels and a phone width of about 390 pixels. The counter and owner screens are designed for a desktop or a tablet in landscape. They work on a phone, but a wider screen is easier for a full day at the counter.

You need an email address to create a customer account. The account is verified through a link sent to that address. On the demonstration site, email delivery is restricted to one address. The confirmation screen always shows the booking reference, so a booking is never lost when an email cannot arrive. The screen says plainly when email will not be delivered.

You need to know which branch you will collect from. The catalogue shows the three branches and whether each one has the model free for your dates. A booking is collected from one branch. The system does not move stock between branches.

2.2 Opening hours and closed days

The branches trade on weekdays from 07:00 to 17:00 and on Saturdays from 07:00 to 13:00. They are closed on Sundays and on South African public holidays. The owner can add a closure day for one branch or for every branch, for example a stocktake.

A hire period counts every calendar day, including a Sunday or a public holiday. A booking cannot start or end on a closed day. If you choose a closed day, the screen explains the problem and offers the next open day. The diary and the counter dashboard show the branch's hours and its closed days.

2.3 The three roles

Role	What the role can do	Where it starts
Customer	Browse, search, book, cancel, see hire history, download a statement and data export	Catalogue home
Counter staff	Find or register a customer, book, check out, take the deposit, return, record damage, find a unit, work the overdue list	Counter dashboard
Owner	See the business dashboard and report, manage the catalogue and fleet, manage users, read the audit trail, correct charges, add closure days, anonymise a customer	Business overview

A customer cannot open the counter or owner screens. Counter staff cannot open the owner screens. The server checks the role, not only the menu.

3. Getting an account

3.1 Create a customer account

1. Open the live site.
2. Choose **Sign in** in the header.
3. Choose **Go to the registration screen**.
4. Fill in your name, email address, phone number, identity document type and the last four characters of the document number.
5. Fill in your billing address and choose your home branch.
6. Read the privacy notice and tick the box that says you accept it.
7. Choose **Create my account**.

The screen tells you whether the verification email can be delivered. On the demonstration site it may say that email is restricted. The account is still created.

3.2 Verify your email

1. Open the message sent to your email address.
2. Follow the verification link.
3. The site opens the verification screen and confirms the result.

If the link has expired, sign in and ask for a new verification message. A verification link can be used once.

3.3 Sign in

1. Choose **Sign in**.
2. Enter your email address and password.
3. Choose **Sign in**.

The site returns you to the screen you were trying to open. If you started from the basket, you return to the basket. If you started from a protected page, you return there.

Five wrong passwords lock the account for a short period. The screen tells you when you may try again. A locked account is not deleted. Wait for the period to pass, or use **Forgotten your password?**

3.4 Forgotten password

1. Choose **Sign in**.
2. Choose **Forgotten your password?**
3. Enter your email address.
4. Choose the button to send the reset link.
5. Open the message and follow the link.
6. Choose a new password of at least twelve characters.
7. Sign in with the new password.

The screen answers in the same way whether or not an address has an account. This is deliberate. It does not reveal which addresses are registered.

3.5 Edit your details

1. Sign in.
2. Open **Account**.
3. Choose **Edit my details**.

4. Change your name, phone number or billing address.
5. Choose **Save the changes**.

Your email address is the account name and is not edited on this screen. The identity document details are used for the hire record and are not shown in full after registration.

4. Customer guide

4.1 Find a tool

1. Open the catalogue home.
2. Choose **Collect on** and **Bring back on**. The return day is not charged.
3. Choose **See what is free**.
4. The results screen lists the models that are free for those dates. Each result says whether each branch can supply it.
5. Choose a branch from **Collect from** to narrow the list to that branch.
6. Type a tool or a make into the search box to narrow the list further.
7. Choose **See dates and book** on the model you want.

The search is kept in the address bar. A reload or a shared link brings the same dates, branch and search back.

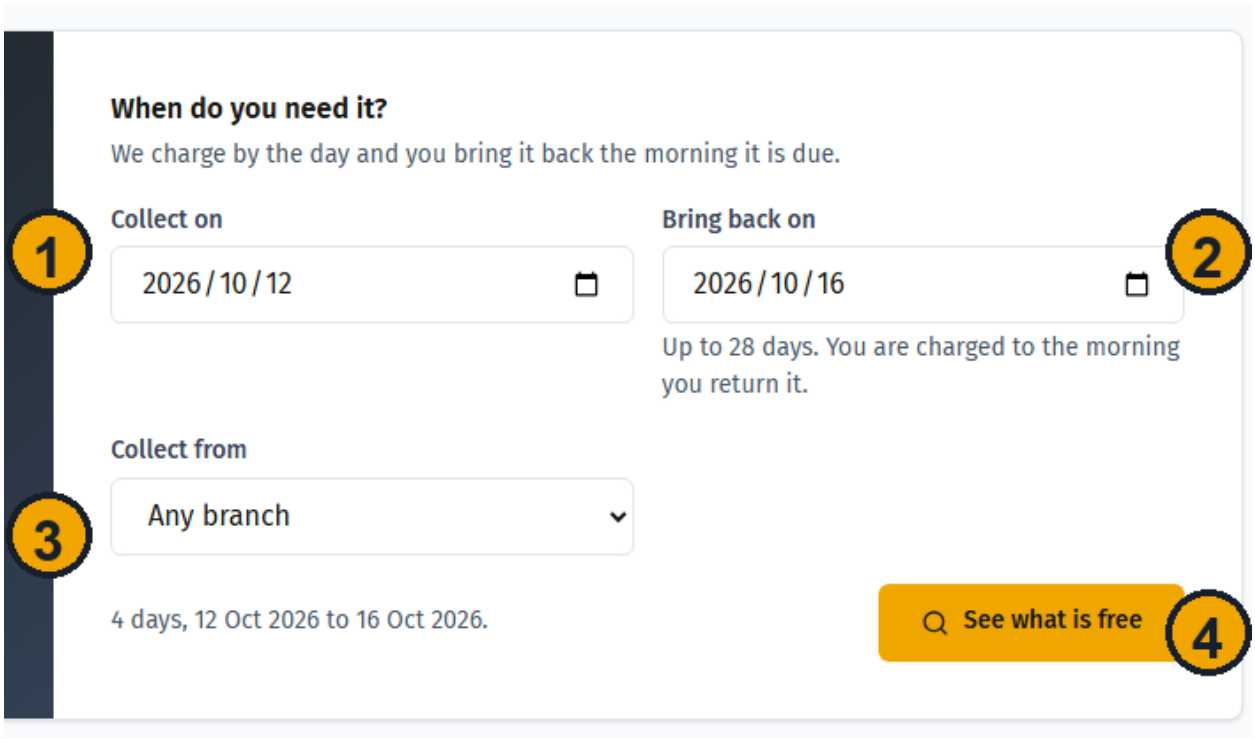


***Figure** 1: The search form on SC-01. 1 choose the collection date, 2 choose the return date, 3 choose a branch, 4 search.*

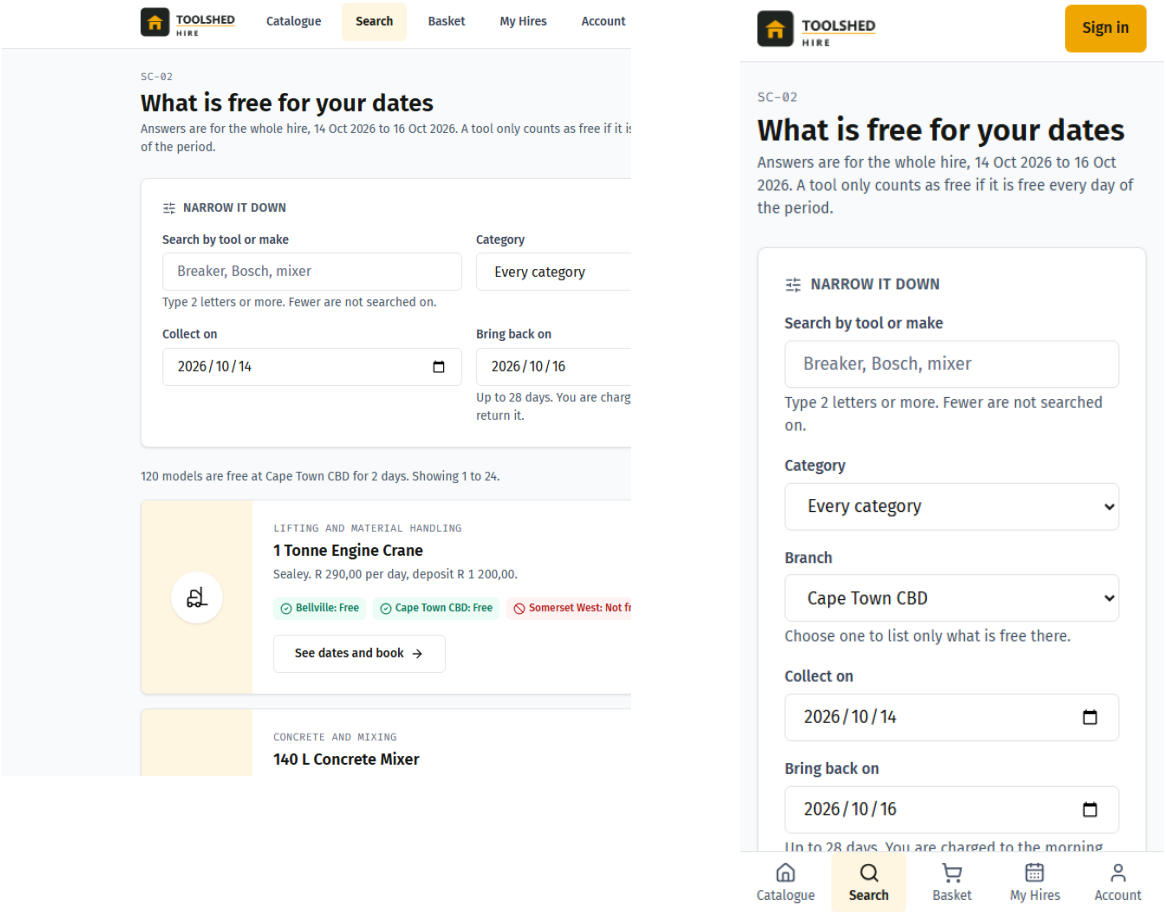


***Figure** 2: SC-02 Availability Search Results, desktop and phone*

4.2 Read a model

The model screen shows the daily rate, the weekly rate, the refundable deposit, the late fee and the hire limits. The booking card repeats the price for your dates and the quantity you choose.

1. Check the model name, the make and the description.
2. Check **Price for these dates**.
3. Choose the branch under **Collect from**.
4. Choose the quantity with **One fewer** or **One more**.
5. Choose **Add to my hire basket**.

A branch is shown as free only when it can supply the full quantity for every day of the period. The screen does not show a stock count. It tells you whether the branch can supply what you asked for.

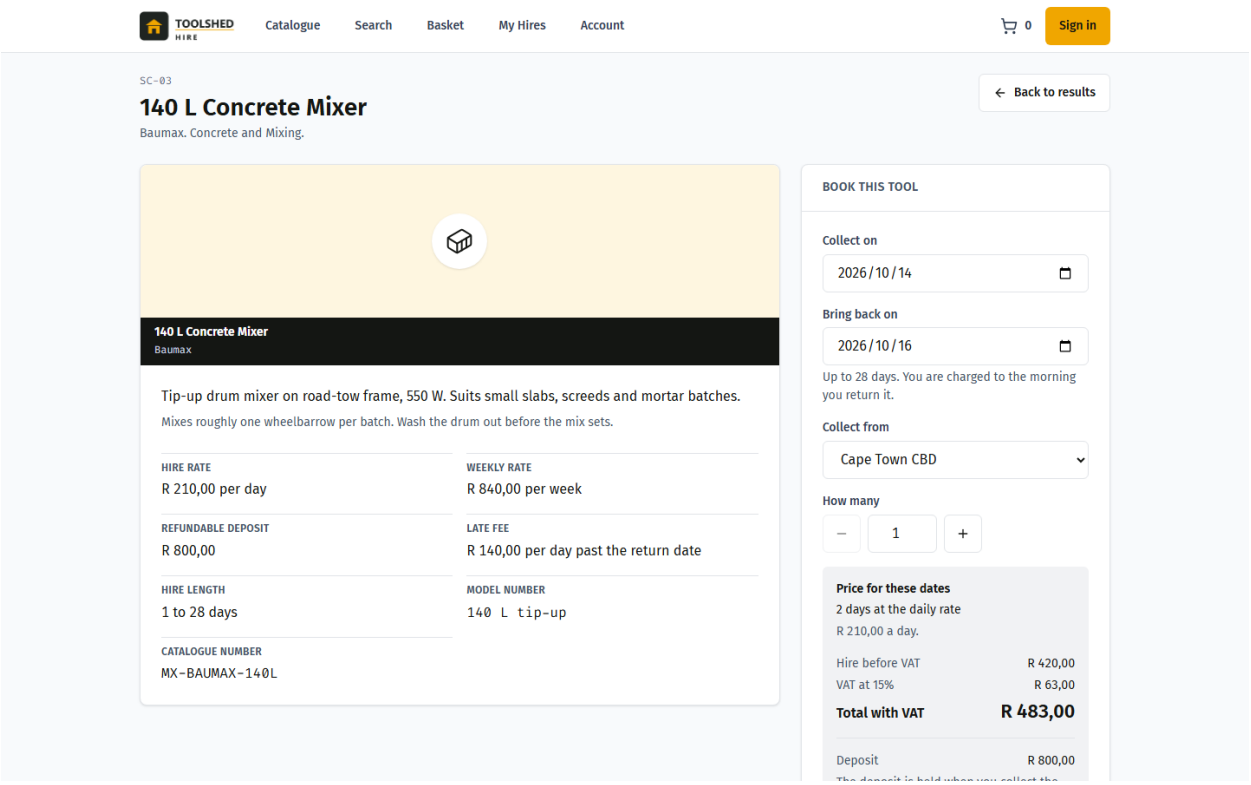


***Figure** 3: SC-03 Product Model Detail with the server's quote for the chosen dates*

4.3 The basket

1. Choose **Go to my basket** after adding a model.
2. Check the dates, the branch and the quantity.
3. Choose **Review and book**.
4. If you are not signed in, the site asks you to sign in and returns you to the basket.

The basket is kept in the browser tab. A reload keeps it. Closing the tab clears it. The basket holds a draft booking, not a confirmed hire.

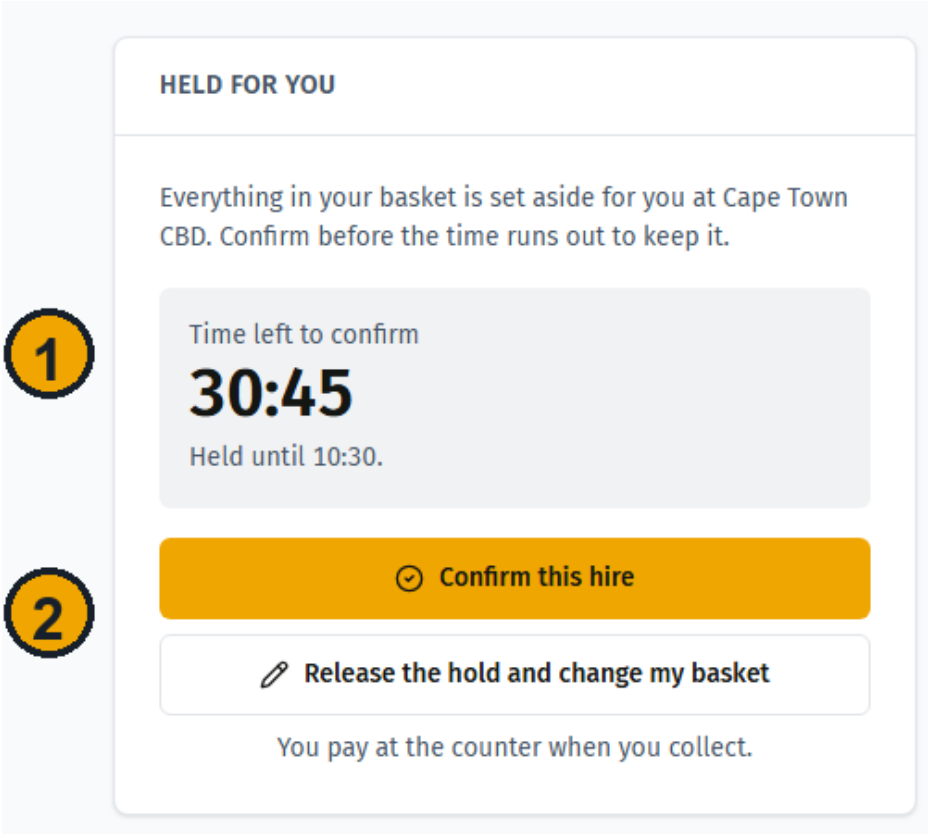


***Figure** 4: The hold step on SC-04. 1 the countdown, 2 confirm before it reaches zero.*

4.4 Review, hold and confirm

1. Review the cost. The server prices the basket.
2. Check **Total with VAT** and **Deposit**.
3. Choose **Hold this equipment**.
4. The equipment is held for thirty minutes. The countdown is on the screen.
5. Choose **Confirm this hire** before the countdown reaches zero.
6. The confirmation screen gives you a booking reference such as TSH-R-26-000124.

The hold is a real reservation. Another customer cannot book the same unit while the hold is running. If the countdown runs out, the equipment goes back on the shelf and you must hold it again. The basket is not lost.

The confirmation screen says whether a confirmation email can be delivered. The booking reference on the screen is the record even when the email cannot arrive.

4.5 My hires

1. Choose **My hires** in the header.
2. The list shows every booking, newest first.
3. A booking shows its reference, status, branch, dates and total.
4. Choose **View booking** to open it.

The statuses you may see are Draft, Held, Confirmed, Collected, Returned, Cancelled, No show and Expired. A confirmed booking can be cancelled online. A collected hire is cancelled through the counter because the equipment is already with you.

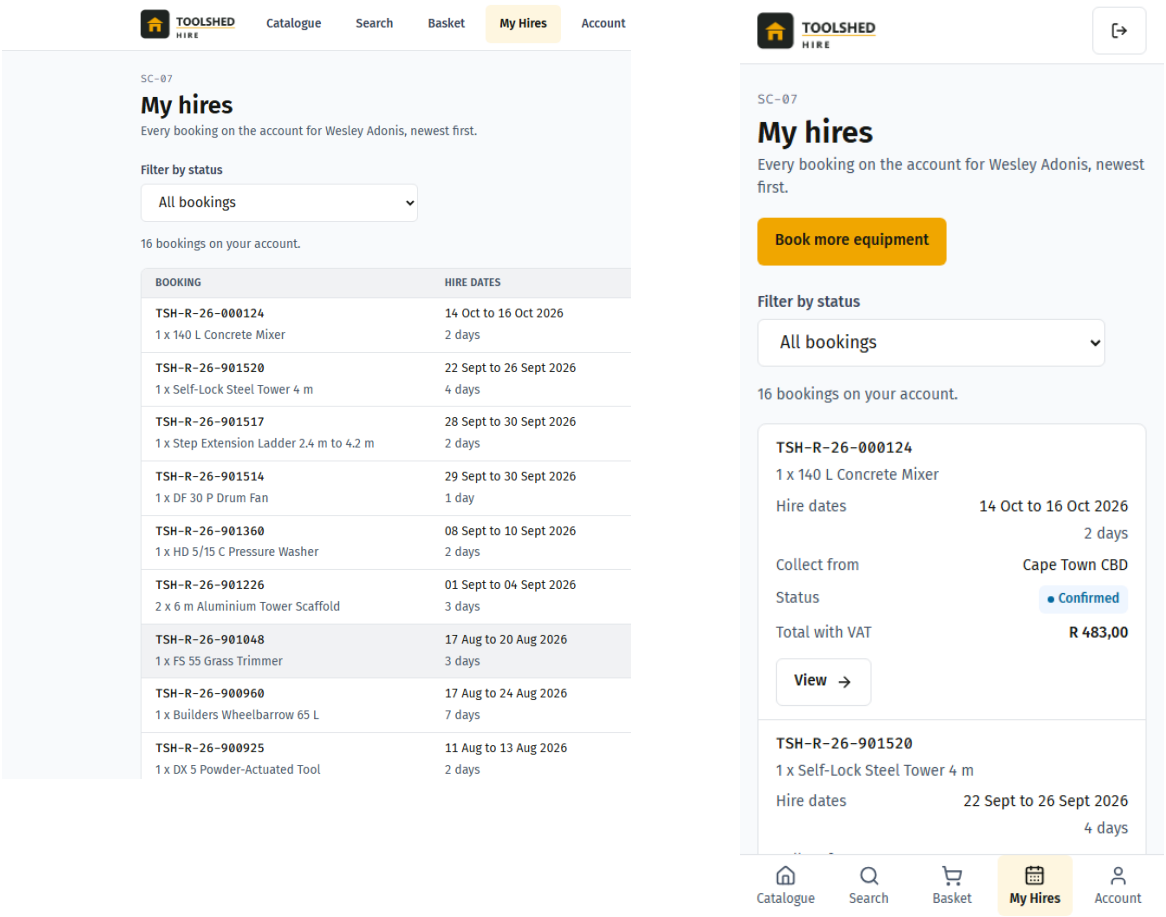


***Figure** 5: SC-07 My Hires, the customer's own bookings newest first*

4.6 Cancel a booking

1. Open the booking from **My hires**.
2. Choose **Cancel this booking**.
3. Give a reason. The reason is written to the record, not published to other customers.
4. Choose **Yes, cancel this booking**.
5. The screen confirms the cancellation.

A cancellation after 17:00 on the day before collection counts as a late cancellation. The system records it against the account. Repeated late cancellations can put the account on hold.

4.7 My account, statement and data export

Account shows your profile, your hire history and your charges. It also has the two documents the POPIA right of access needs.

1. Choose **Account**.
2. Choose a period for the statement.
3. Choose **Download my statement** for a CSV, or open the printable statement and print it to PDF.
4. Choose **Download all my data** for a JSON file of the personal data the system holds about you.

The statement is read from the ledger. It shows the hires, the charges, the deposit movements and the balance for the period. The data export is built from the personal data map, so a new table that holds customer data is included when the map is updated. The export does not include a password or a refresh token.

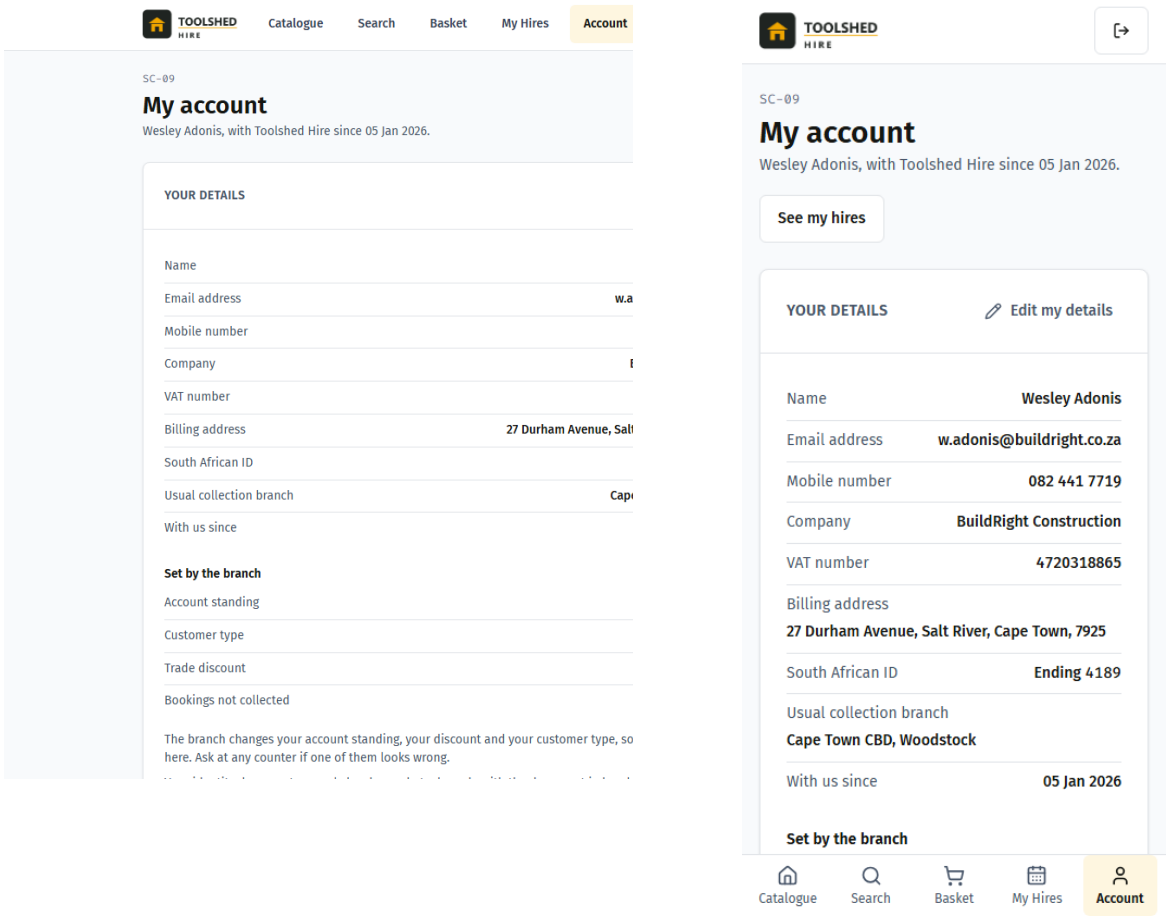


***Figure** 6: SC-09 My Account and Hire History, desktop and phone*

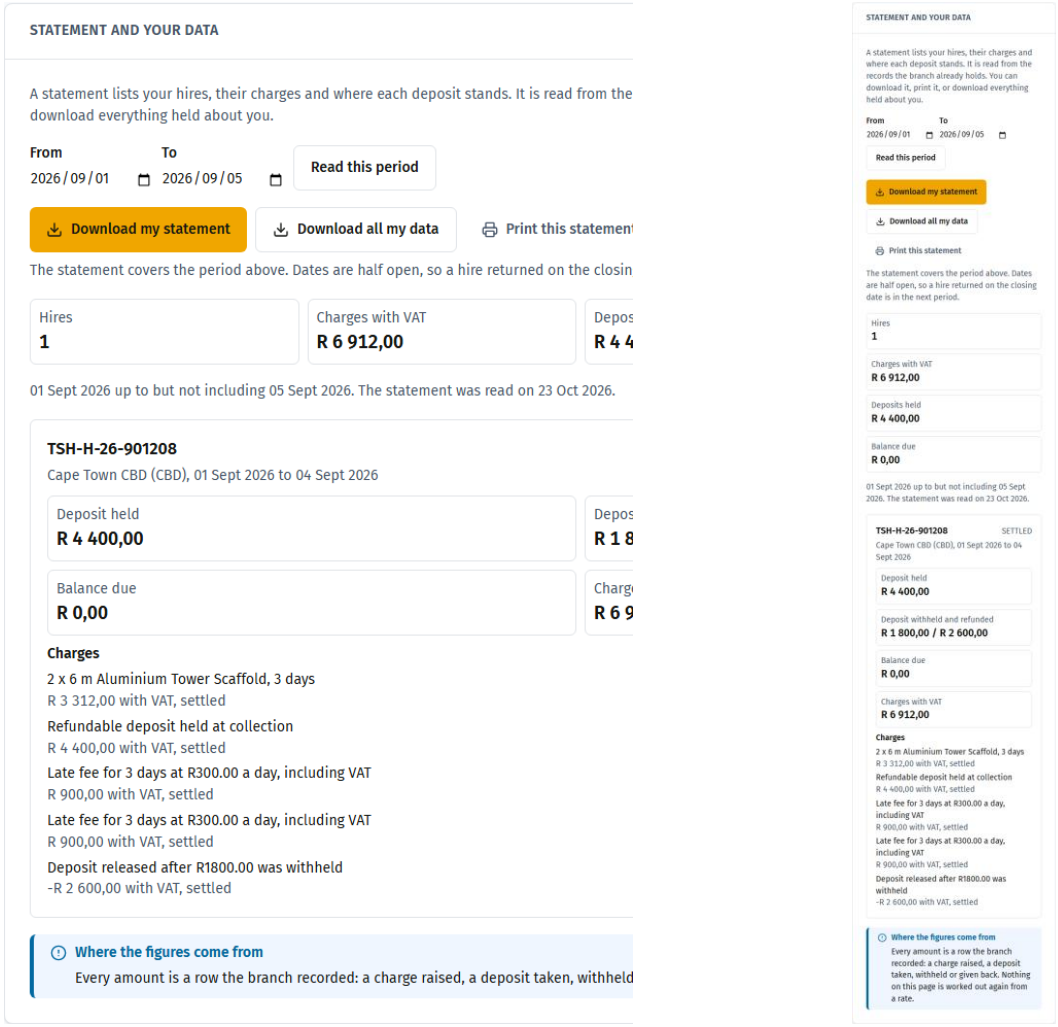


Figure 7: SC-09 statement with the period, CSV download, print and data export controls

4.8 Damage photographs on your hire

If the counter records damage to a unit on your hire, the evidence is attached to the hire. You can see it on the hire in **Account**.

1. Open **Account** and the hire history.
2. Open the hire with the damage record.
3. Choose the photograph to open a short-lived signed link.

A photograph of another customer's hire is not shown to you. The server checks ownership and answers as if the record does not exist.

4.9 Privacy notice

The privacy notice is linked in the footer of every screen. It names the operators that process personal data, what each one holds and where it is held. It states the five-year retention period for financial records and the two-year period after the last hire for personal details. It explains the right of access and the data export.

5. Counter staff guide

The counter screens are for a signed-in member of staff at one branch. The branch is chosen at sign-in and is shown at the top of the screen. Every booking, checkout and return belongs to that branch unless the screen says otherwise.

5.1 Start the day

1. Sign in with your staff email address and password.
2. The counter dashboard opens for your branch.
3. Check **Today at the counter** for collections, returns and overdue units.
4. Open **Diary** to see the day's bookings and the branch's open hours.

The dashboard and the diary are read-only. They do not change a hire. A red or amber item is a prompt to act, not an automatic charge.

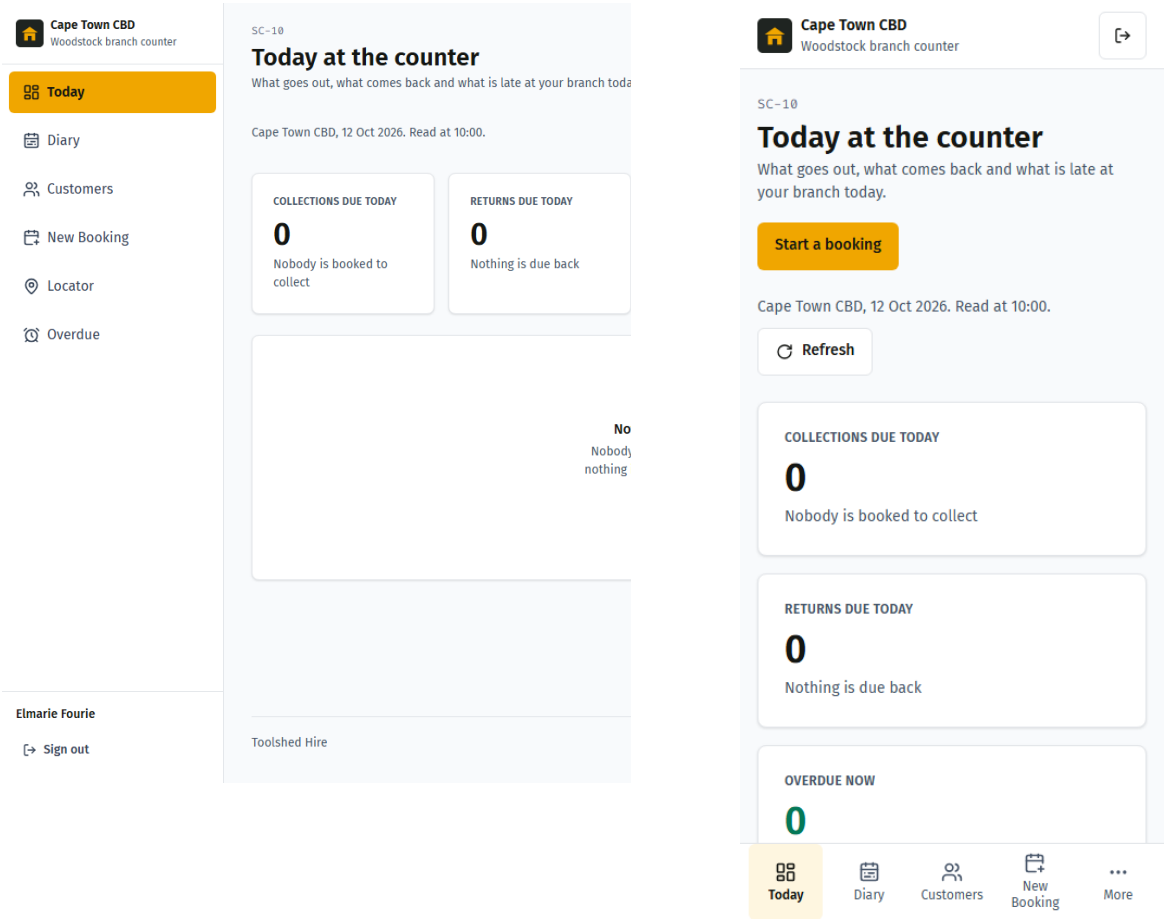


***Figure** 8: SC-10 Counter Dashboard for Cape Town CBD, desktop and phone*

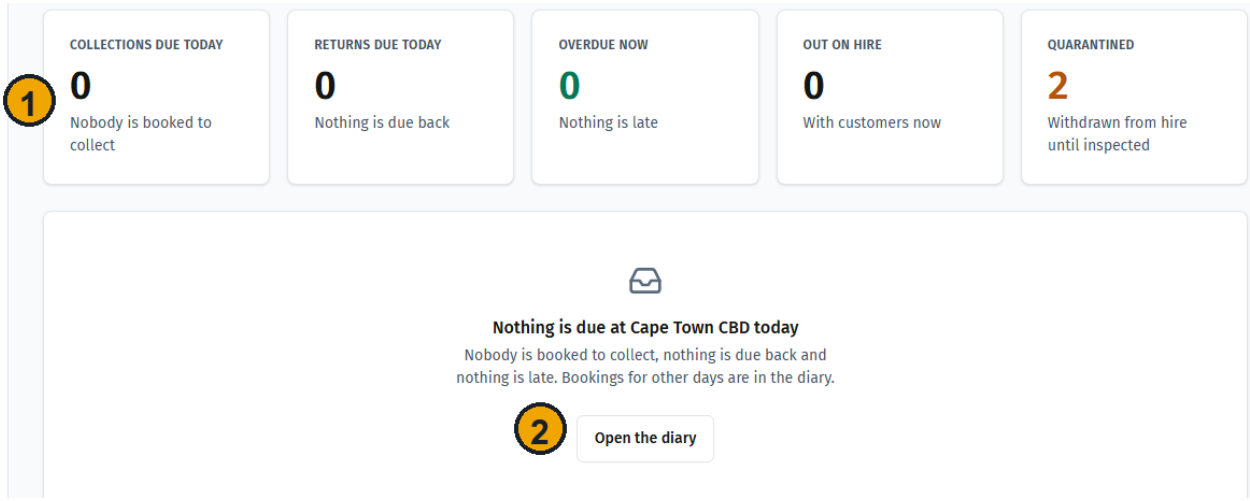


***Figure** 9: The day at a glance on SC-10. 1 the five counters, 2 open the diary.*

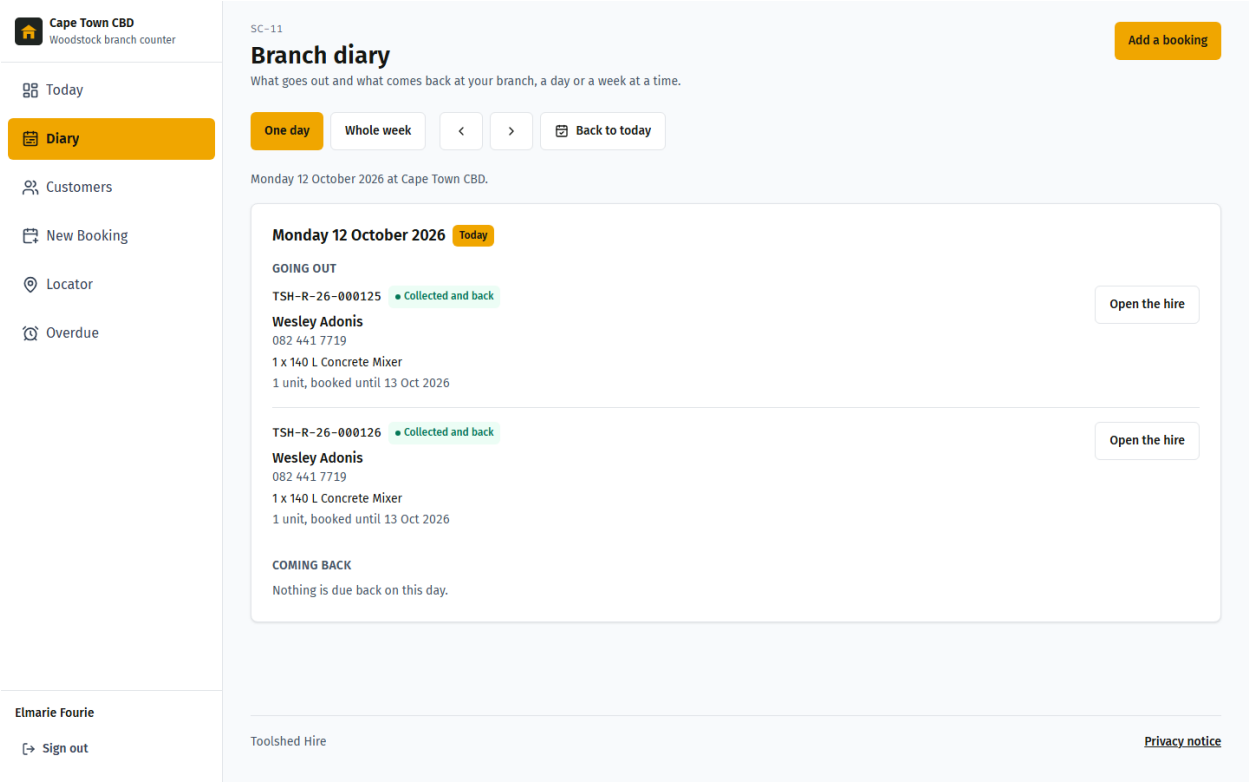


***Figure** 10: SC-11 Branch Diary for the day, with what goes out and what comes back*

5.2 Find a customer

1. Open **Customers**.
2. Type part of a name, a phone number or an email address into **Search customers**.
3. The results show the best match first, with the account standing.
4. Choose **New booking** beside the customer.
5. If the customer does not have an account, register a walk-in on the same screen.

A walk-in needs a full name, a mobile number, the last four characters of the document number and a billing address. The customer does not get a login. The record is still a customer record, so it appears in the hire history and the audit trail.

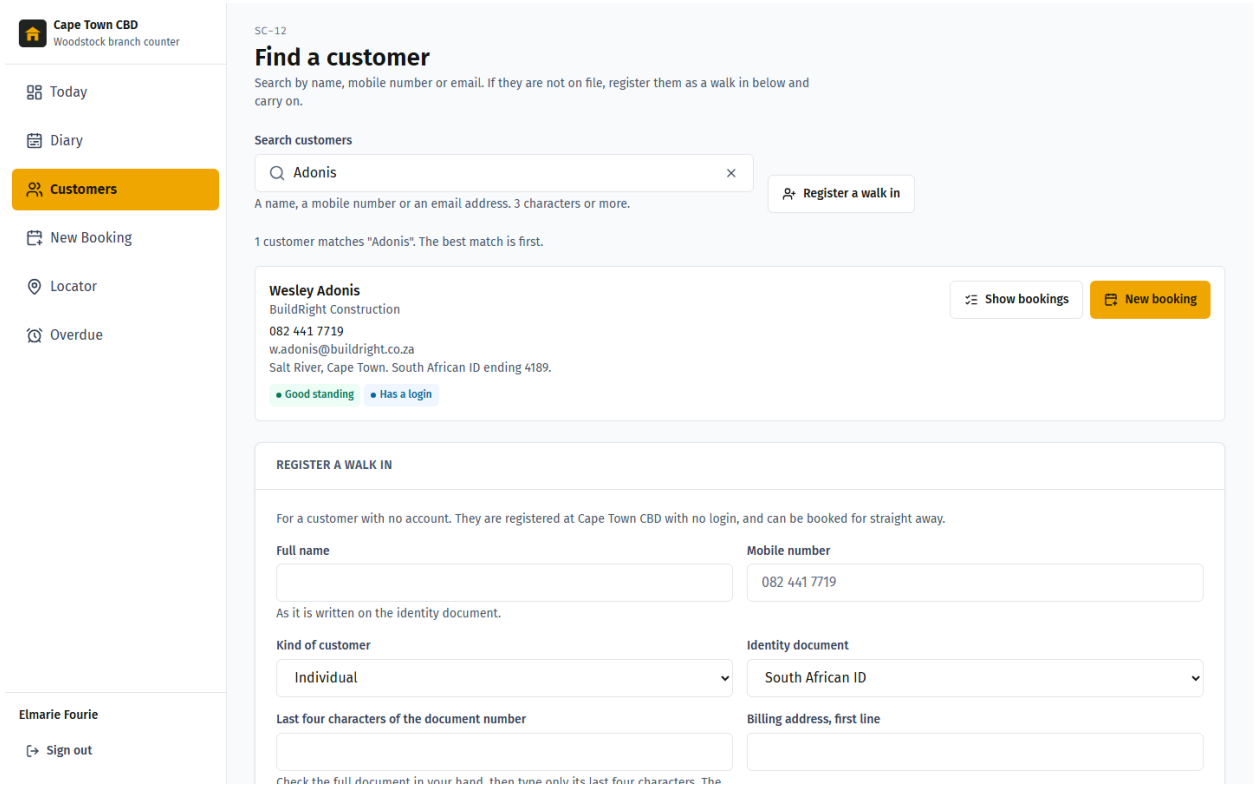


Figure 11: SC-12 Customer Lookup with the trade customer found by name

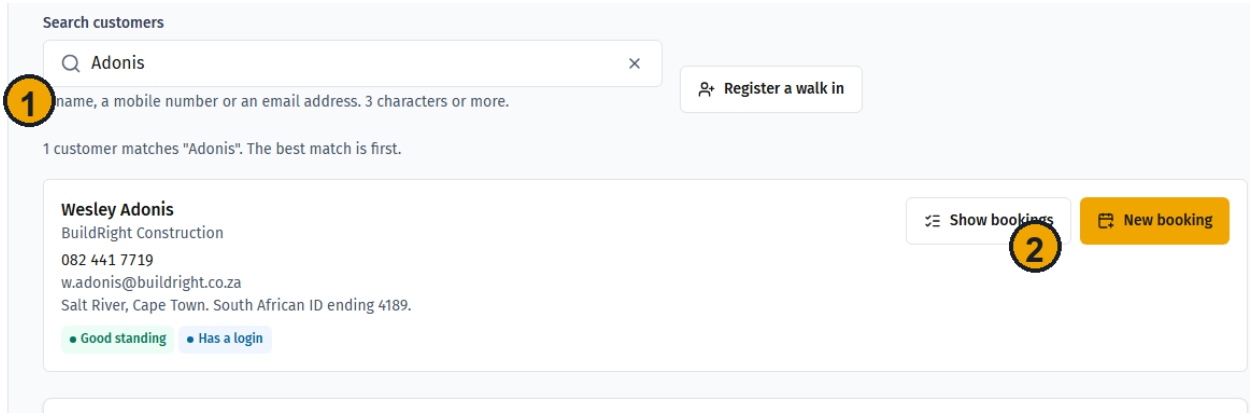


Figure 12: The lookup on SC-12. 1 search by name, phone or email, 2 choose the customer row's New booking.

5.3 Take a booking

1. Open a new booking for the customer.
2. Choose **Goes out on** and **Comes back on**. The first day may be today while the branch is open.
3. Choose **Find a tool** and type a model or a make. Leave it empty to see everything free at the branch.
4. Choose **Add** beside the model. The screen says how many units are free for the dates.
5. Change the quantity if the customer needs more than one.
6. Choose **Work out the cost**. The server prices the booking.
7. Check **Total with VAT** and **Deposit to take at collection**.
8. Choose **Hold the equipment**.
9. Choose **Confirm the booking**.
10. The confirmation shows the booking reference and the units set aside.

The assistant does not choose an asset tag. The server allocates a free unit when the booking is held. The allocation uses the exclusion constraint, so two bookings cannot hold the same unit for overlapping dates.

A booking that starts today can be checked out from the confirmation screen. A booking that starts later must be checked out on its collection day from the customer's bookings. The screen says the date plainly.

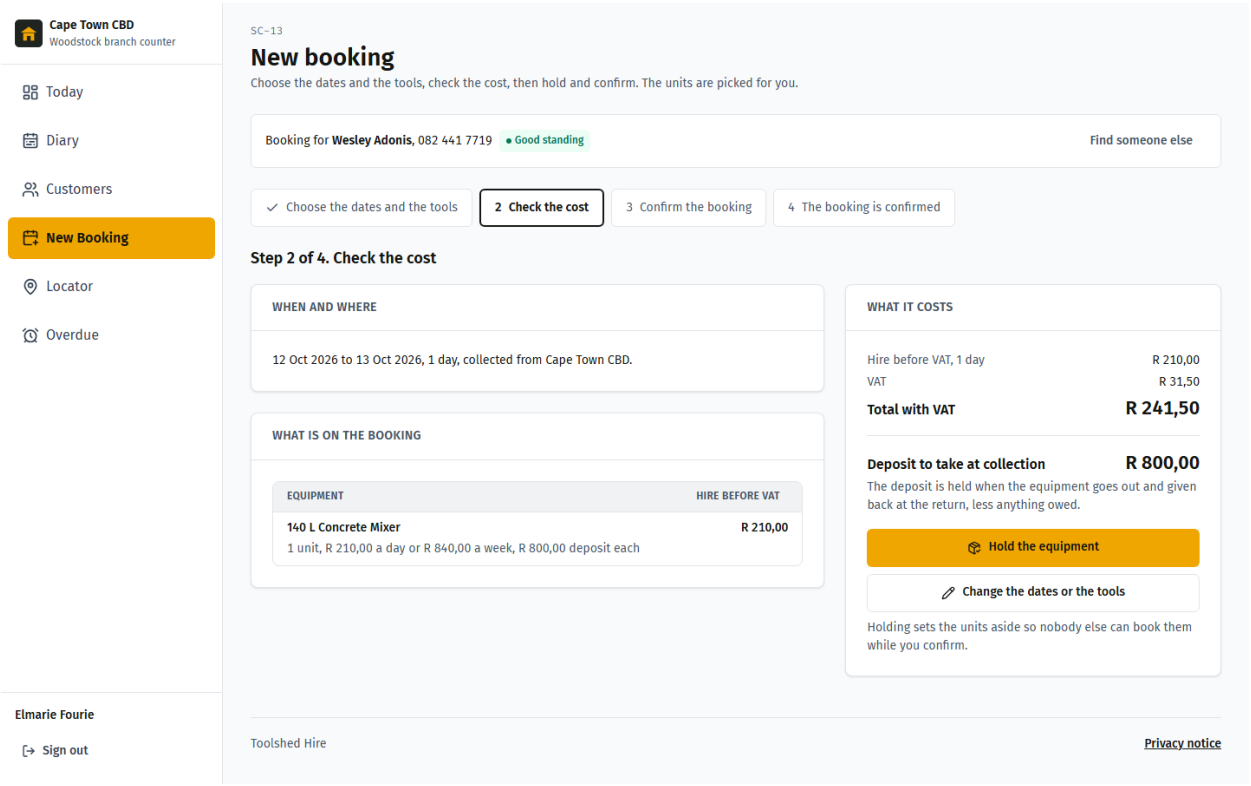


***Figure** 13: SC-13 New Booking at the cost step, priced by the server*

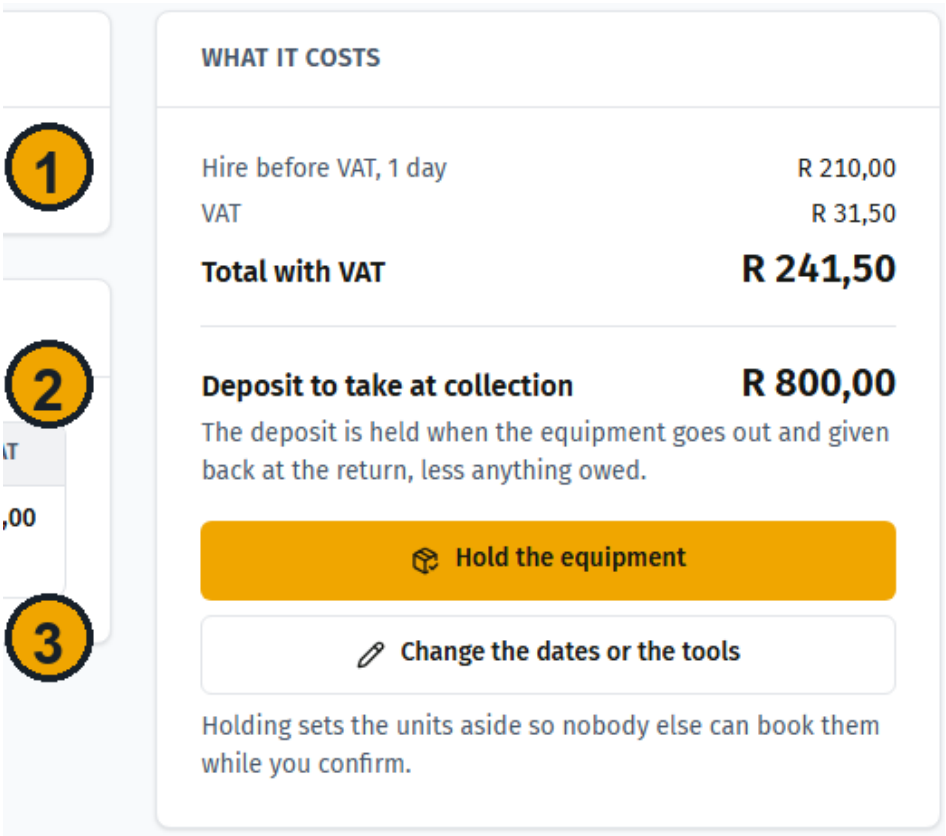


***Figure** 14: The cost panel on SC-13. 1 total with VAT, 2 deposit to take at collection, 3 hold the equipment.*

5.4 Check out and take the deposit

1. Open the confirmed booking.
2. Choose **Check out now**.
3. Read the tag on each unit and tick the box that says you have read it.

4. Tick the box that says the customer read and signed the hire agreement.
5. Choose **Check out the equipment**.
6. Confirm **Yes, hand it over**.
7. Take the deposit shown on the screen.
8. The screen confirms that the equipment is out on hire and gives the hire reference.

The checkout writes the hire, the rental items and the deposit charge in one transaction. A failure leaves the booking confirmed and the unit on the shelf. Nothing is half written.

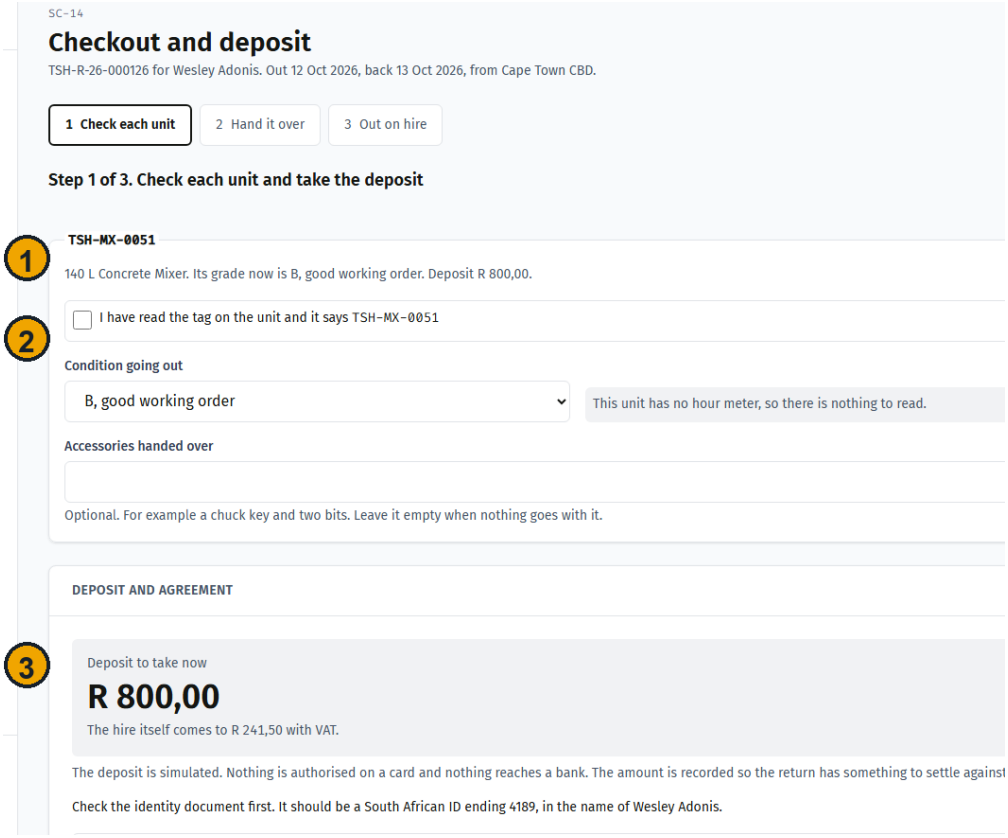


***Figure** 15: The checkout on SC-14. 1 read the tag, 2 record the condition, 3 take the deposit.*

5.5 Take a return

1. Open the hire from the dashboard, the diary or **Overdue**.
2. Choose the unit or units that are back.
3. Record the condition grade and any damage.
4. Choose **Take the ticked units back**.
5. Confirm **Yes, take them back**.
6. The screen shows the deposit settlement and any balance due.

The settlement releases the deposit in full when nothing is owed. A late fee, a damage recovery or a lost unit reduces the release. The screen shows each line, not only the total.

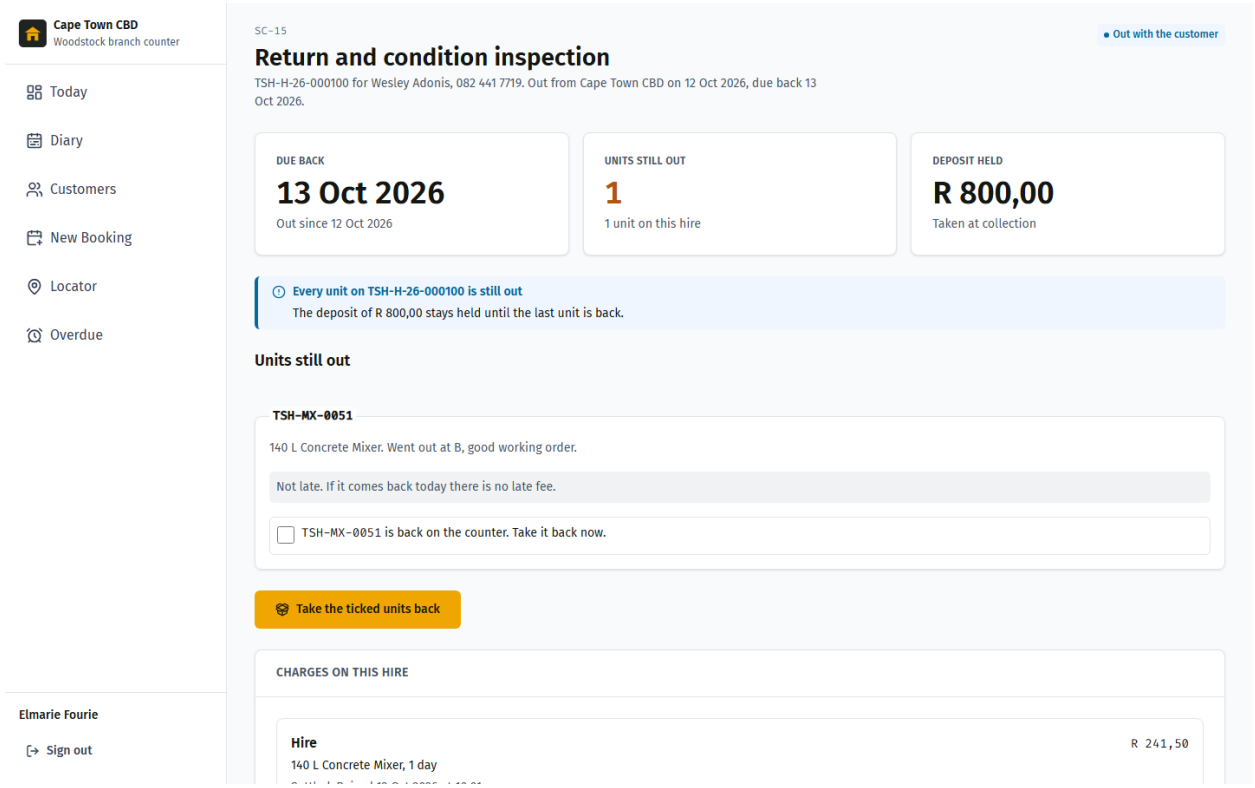


***Figure** 16: SC-15 Return and Condition Inspection, with the deposit settlement*

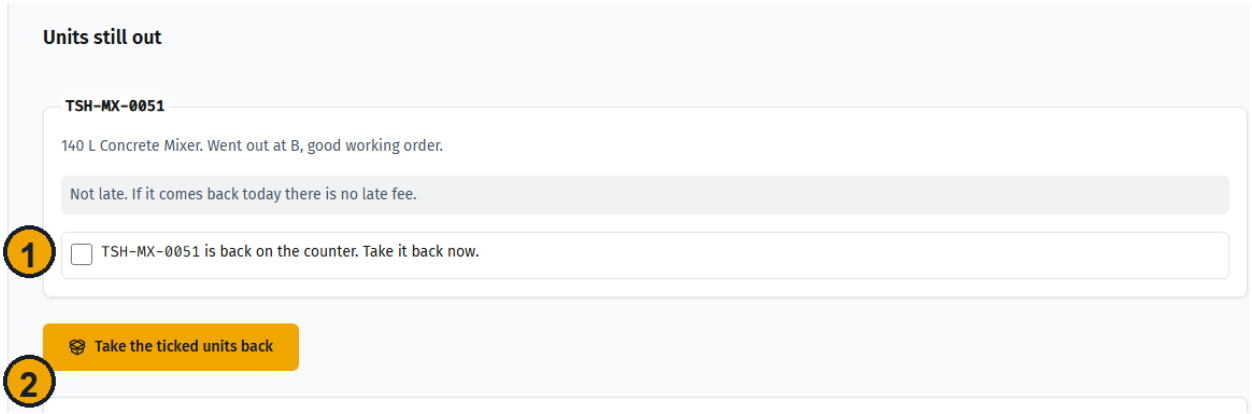


***Figure** 17: The return on SC-15. 1 tick the unit that is back, 2 take the ticked units back.*

5.6 Record damage

1. Open the damage screen from the hire or from the asset locator.
2. Choose the damaged unit.
3. Describe the damage and choose the severity.
4. Add up to six photographs. Each must be a JPEG or PNG, no larger than 4 MB.
5. The server checks the file's magic bytes and re-encodes the image. A file renamed to look like an image is refused.
6. Choose **Record the damage**.

The photographs are held in a private bucket. A signed link expires quickly. Staff, the owner and the customer on the hire can see the photographs. Another customer cannot.

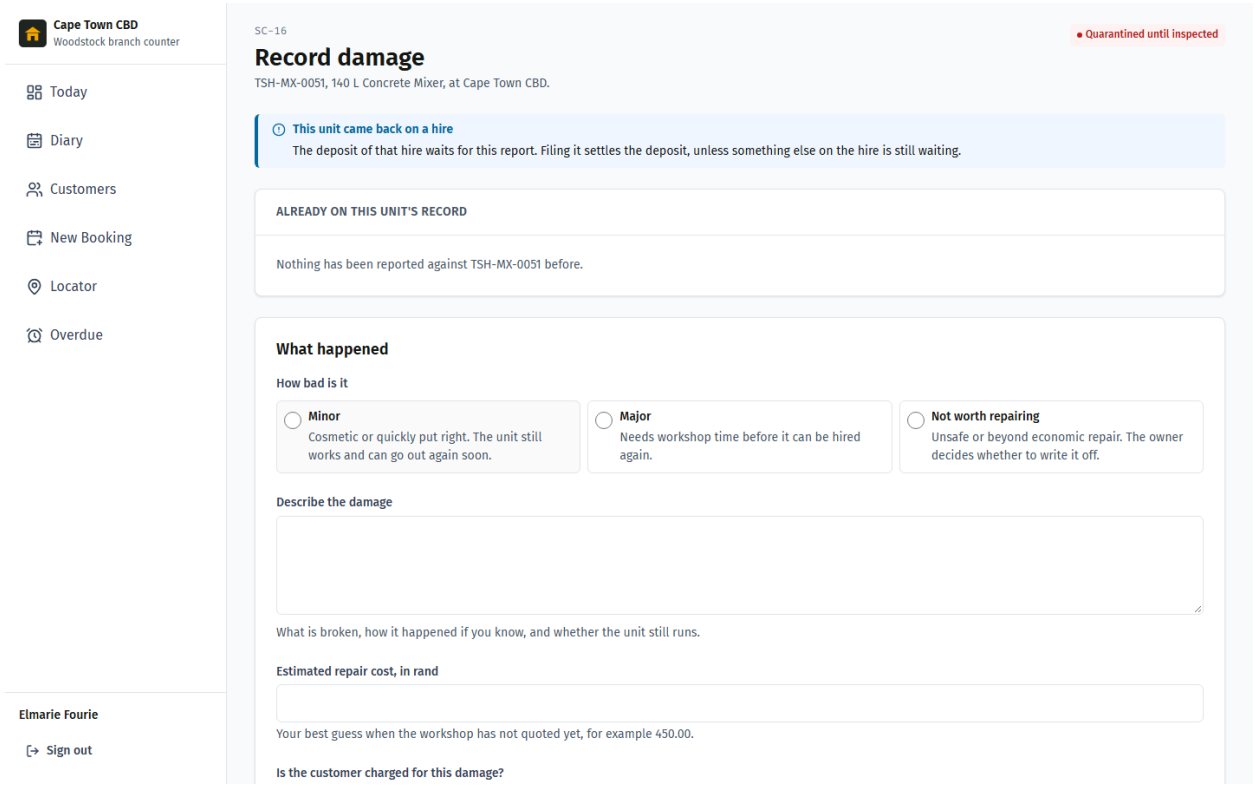


***Figure** 18: SC-16 Damage Report Capture with the photograph upload and its limits*

5.7 Find a unit across the branches

1. Open **Locator**.
2. Type an asset tag or part of a model name. Two characters are enough.
3. The result shows the branch, the state, the condition and the hire the unit is on.
4. A unit that is quarantined or under repair links to its damage reports.

The locator is read-only. It does not move a unit or change a status.

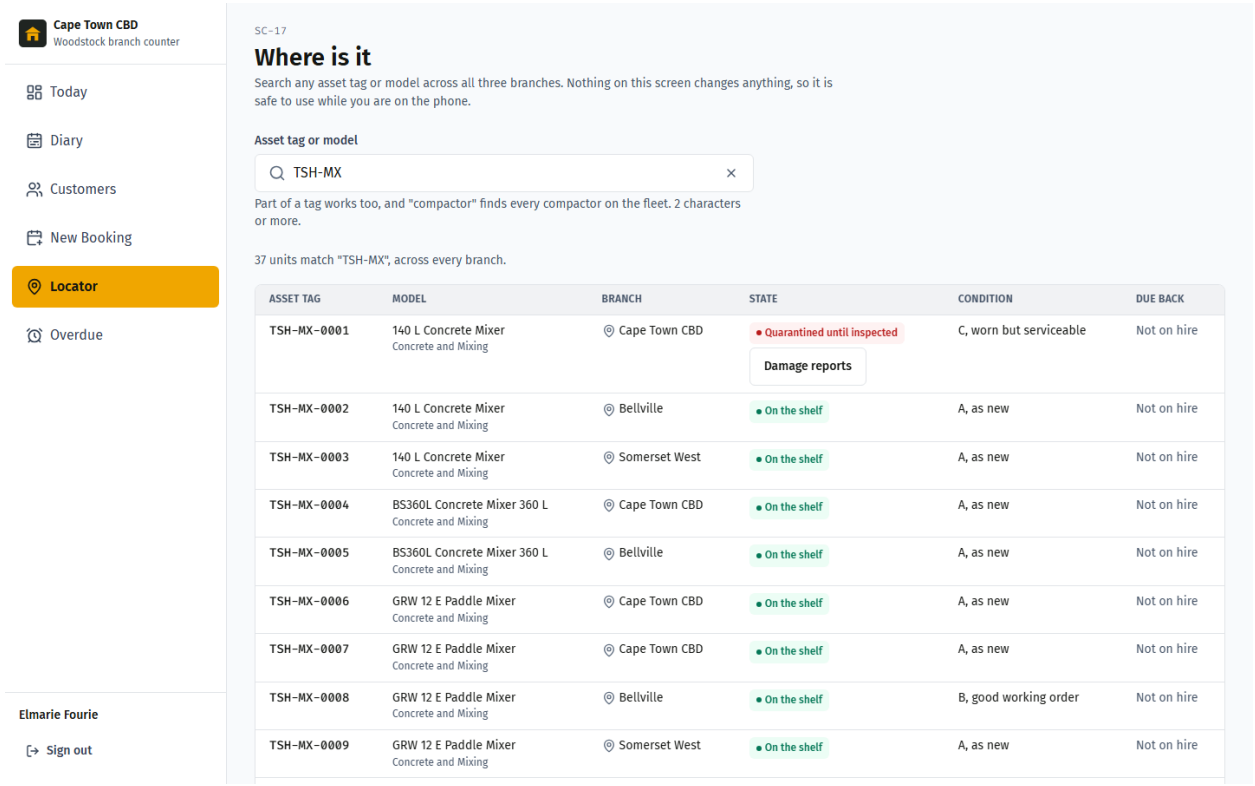


***Figure** 19: SC-17 Asset Locator, with a unit's branch and state*

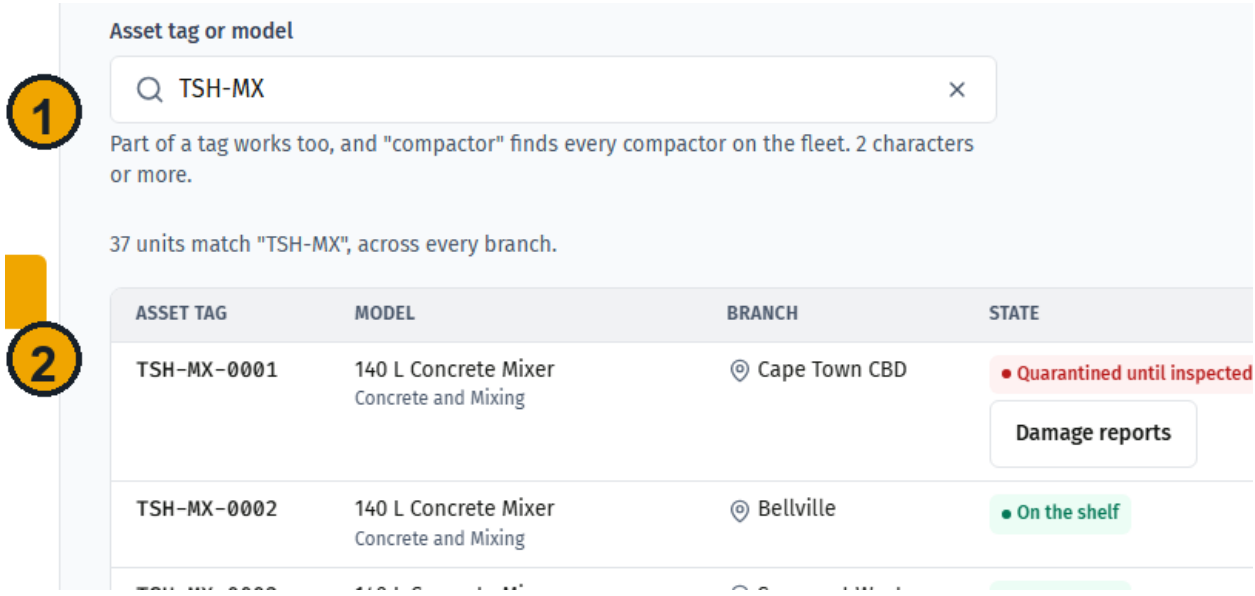


***Figure** 20: The locator on SC-17. 1 search by tag or model, 2 read the branch and state in the result.*

5.8 Work the overdue list

1. Open **Overdue**.
2. The list shows hires past their return date, with the days late and the fee so far.
3. Open a hire to take the return or to record a loss.
4. A no-show is a booking that was never collected. Use the no-show action on the booking, not the return screen.

A late fee is calculated by the same policy at every branch. The counter does not negotiate it. A correction is a separate owner action and is written to the audit trail.

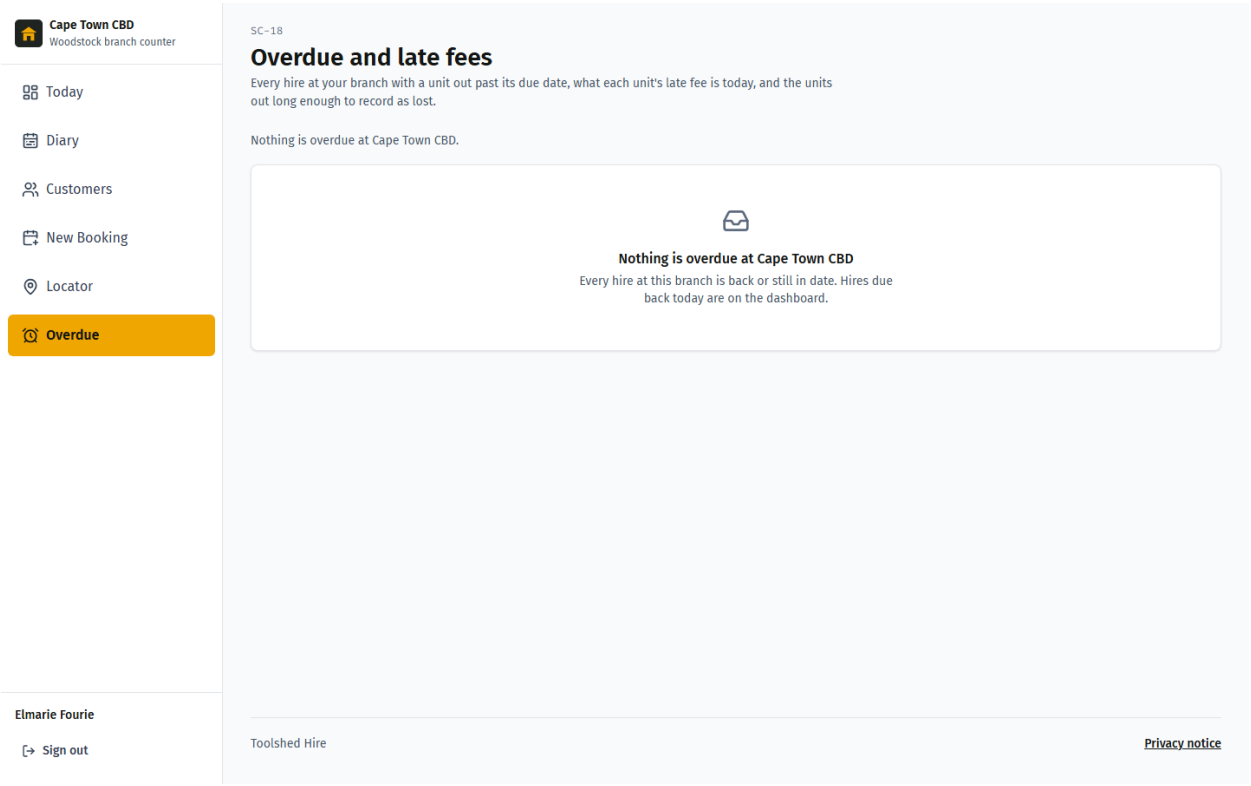


***Figure** 21: SC-18 Overdue and Late Fee Worklist*

5.9 Re-send a confirmation

1. Open the booking.
2. Choose **Send the confirmation again**.
3. The screen says whether the message was queued.
4. The same booking can be re-sent at most three times an hour. Past that, the screen gives a plain refusal.

On the demonstration site, email is restricted. The screen says the message may not arrive. The booking reference is still the record.

6. Owner guide

The owner signs in with the owner account and lands on **Business overview**. The owner sees every branch. The owner can change the catalogue, the fleet, the users, the closure days and a customer's standing. Every change is written to the audit trail.

6.1 The business overview

1. Open **Business overview**.
2. Read the branch cards and the month-to-date figures.
3. Use the report link to open **Utilisation and Gross Contribution**.
4. Use the attention counts to open open damage reports, customers on hold and failed messages.

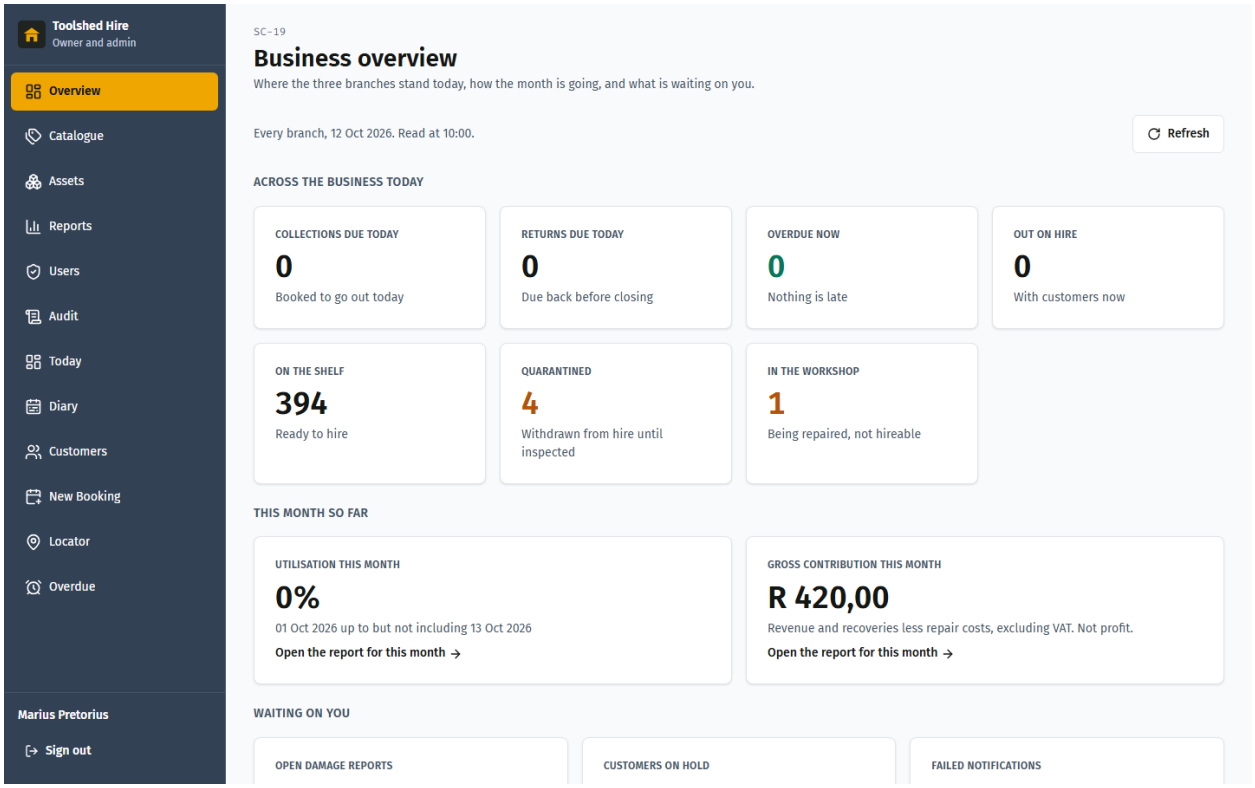


***Figure** 22: SC-19 Admin Dashboard, with the branch cards and the attention counts*

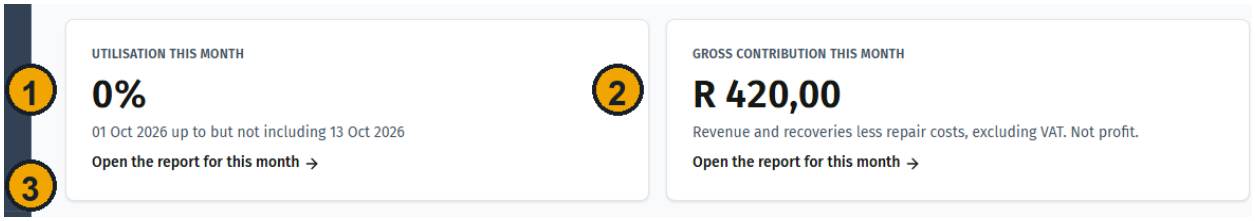


***Figure** 23: The month figures on SC-19. 1 utilisation, 2 gross contribution, 3 open the report for the month.*

6.2 The utilisation and gross contribution report

1. Choose a period. The period may be at most 366 days.
2. Choose how to group the lines. The report can group by unit, model, category or branch.
3. Choose a branch or a category filter if you need one.
4. Choose **Run the report**.
5. Read the two definitions on the screen. Utilisation is the share of serviceable days on hire. Gross contribution is hire revenue plus late fees plus damage recovery, less repair costs.

6. Choose **Download the CSV** for the same figures.

A day is a business day in Cape Town. A hire that goes out at 00:30 belongs to the new day. A deposit is not revenue. A waived charge counts nothing. A reversal is a negative row and nets the charge it reverses.

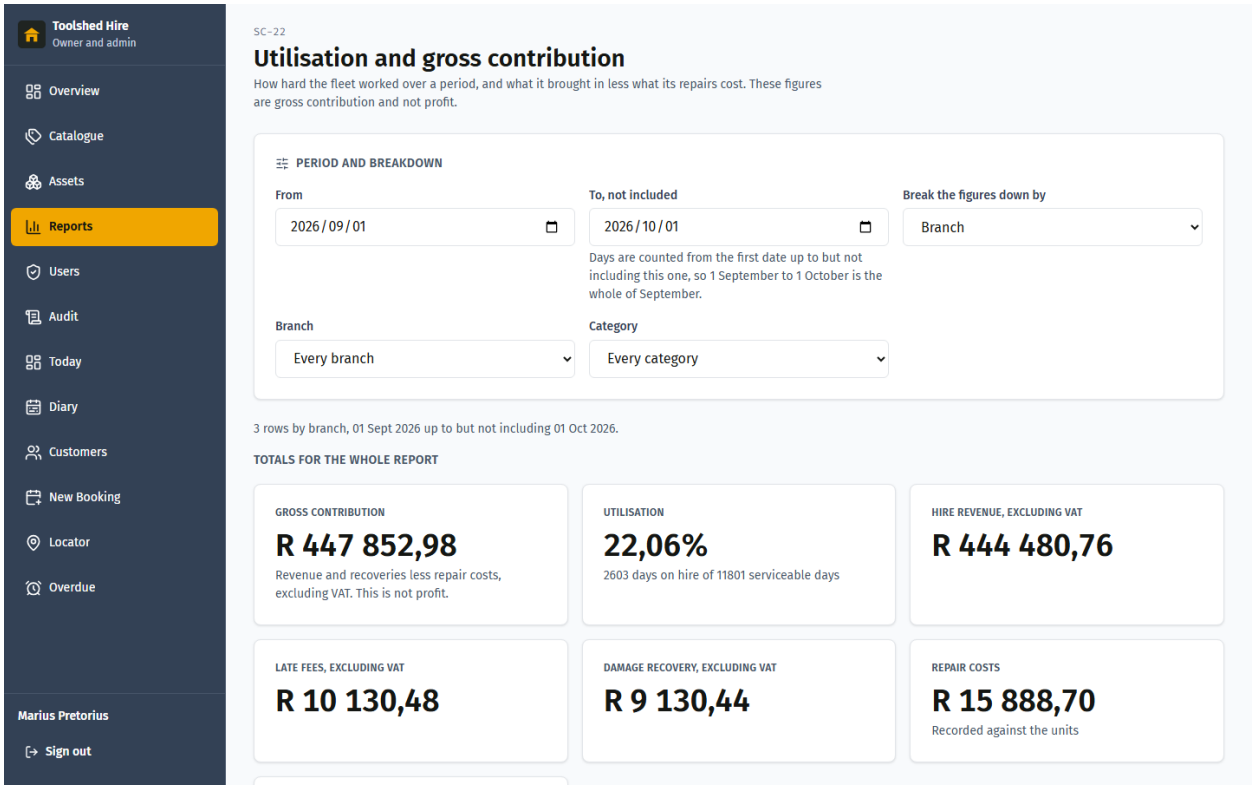


***Figure** 24: SC-22 Utilisation and Gross Contribution Report, with the two definitions*

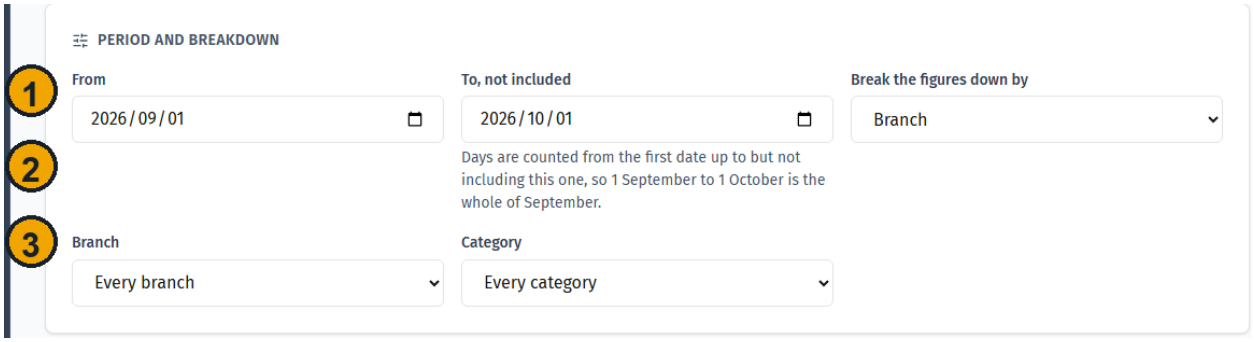


***Figure** 25: The report filters on SC-22. 1 the period, 2 the breakdown, 3 a branch or category filter.*

6.3 Catalogue and pricing

1. Open **Catalogue**.
2. Choose a model.
3. Change the daily rate, the weekly rate, the deposit or the late fee.
4. Save the change and confirm it.
5. The new price applies to the next booking. An existing booking keeps the price it was quoted.

A model can be hidden from customers. Hiding a model does not delete it and does not change a booking that already uses it. A new category can be added from the same screen.

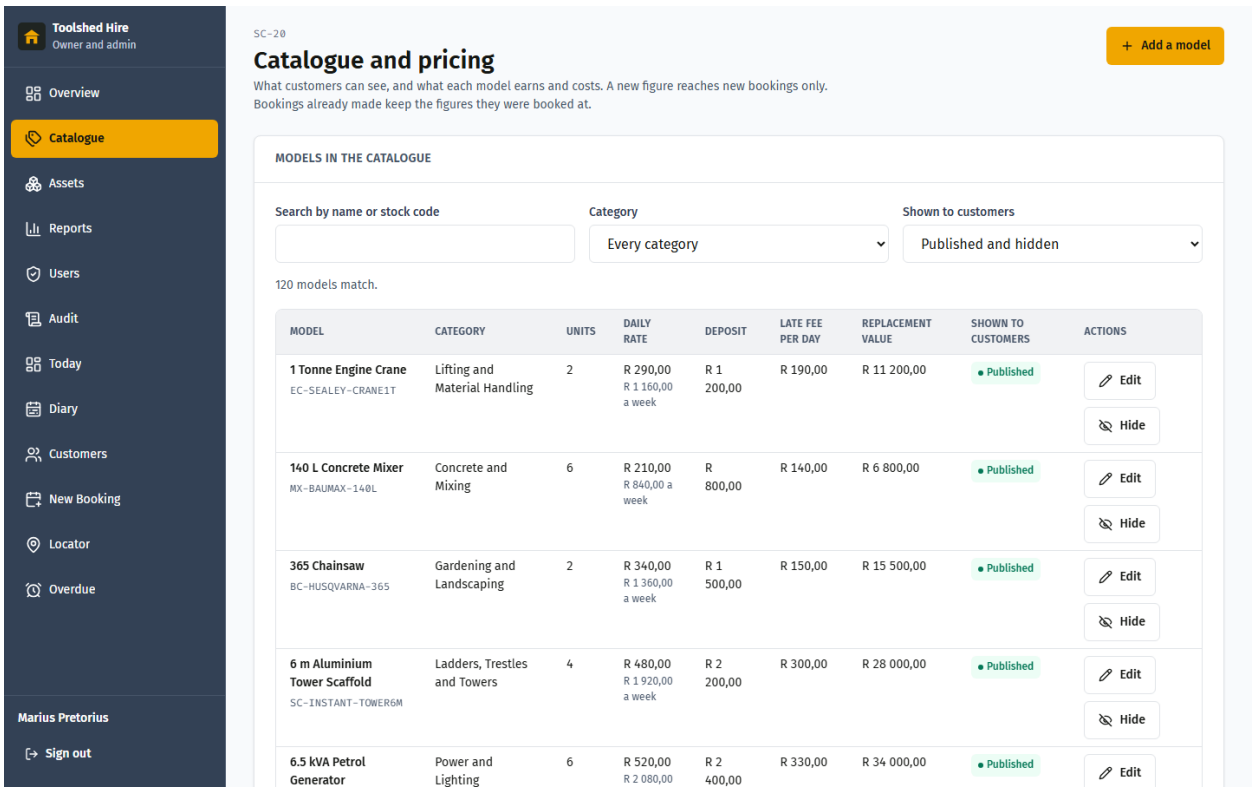


***Figure** 26: SC-20 Catalogue and Pricing Management*

6.4 Asset register and lifecycle

1. Open **Assets**.
2. Search by tag, model, branch or state.
3. Open a unit to see its history, its allocations, its hires, its damage reports and its status changes.
4. Register a new unit with a tag, a model and a branch.
5. Move a unit through intake, available, quarantined, under repair, retired or lost as the real state changes.

A tag never changes. A unit's history is read from the records, not typed in. A status change is written to the audit trail.

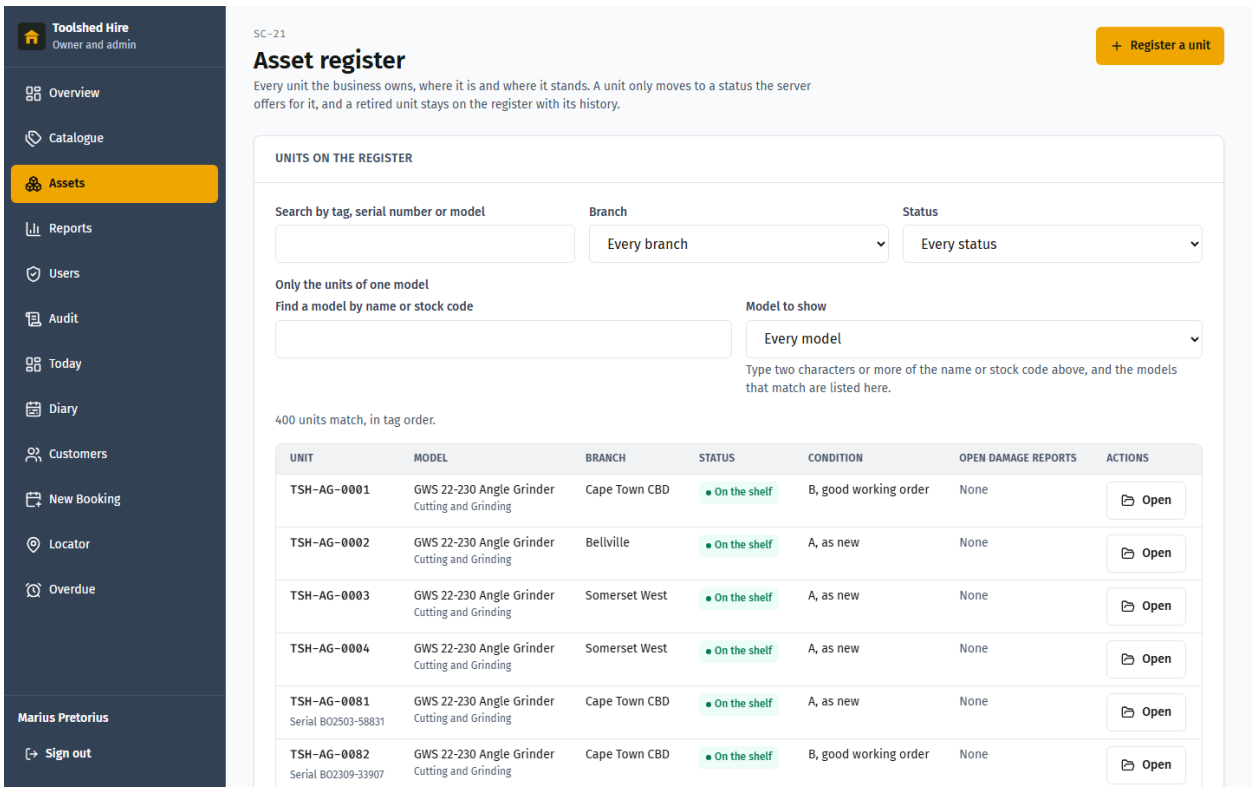


***Figure** 27: SC-21 Asset Register and Lifecycle*

6.5 Users and roles

1. Open **Users**.
2. Choose a member of staff or a customer.
3. Open or deactivate a staff account. A new staff member chooses their own password through a one-time link.
4. Set or clear a trade customer's discount.
5. Put a customer on hold or release the hold.
6. Anonymise a customer on request. The confirm step says what is removed and what stays.

The owner cannot read a staff password. The account creation writes a random hash that is thrown away, and the person chooses their own password from the link.

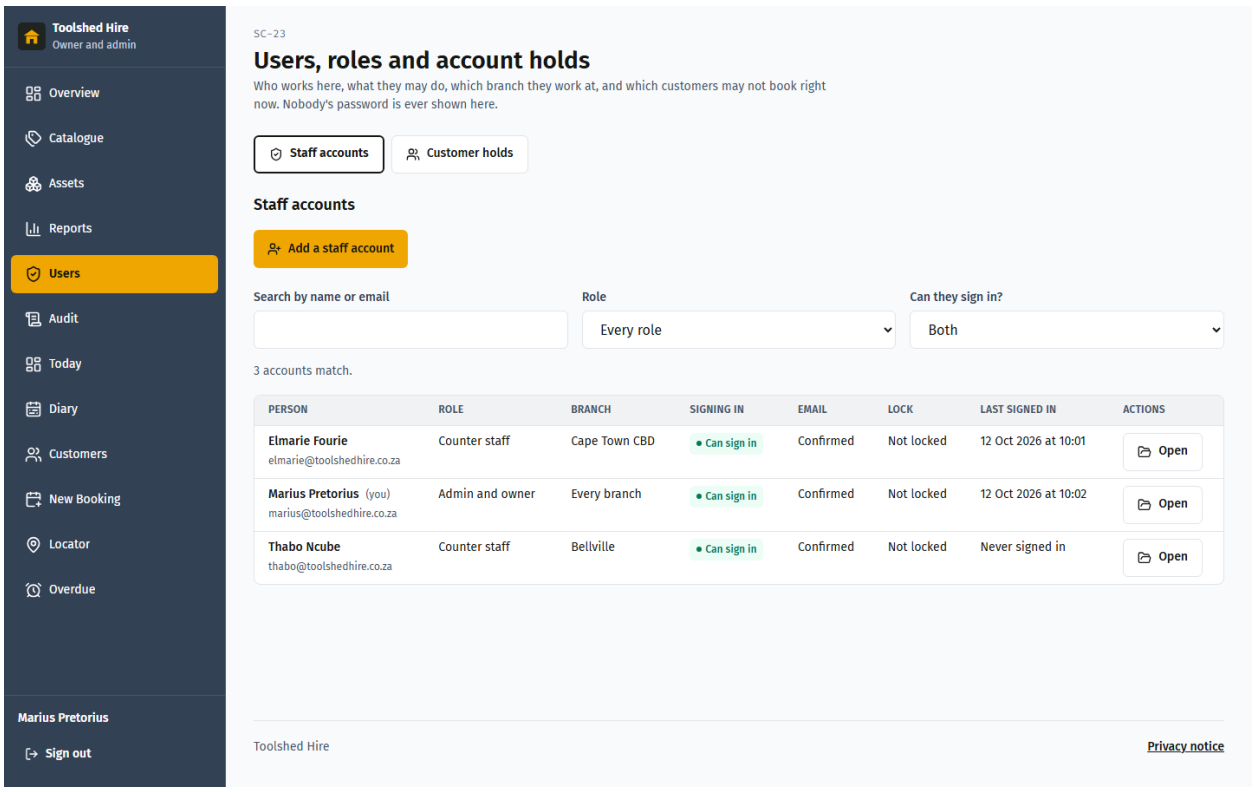


***Figure** 28: SC-23 User and Role Management*

6.6 Audit and notification log

1. Open **Audit trail**.
2. Filter by date, actor, action or entity.
3. Open an event to read what changed.
4. Open **Notifications** to see every message and its delivery state.
5. Use **Send again** on a failed message when the customer asks.

The audit trail is append-only. A correction is a new event, not an edit of the old one. The notification log records the recipient, the template, the attempt and the provider's answer.

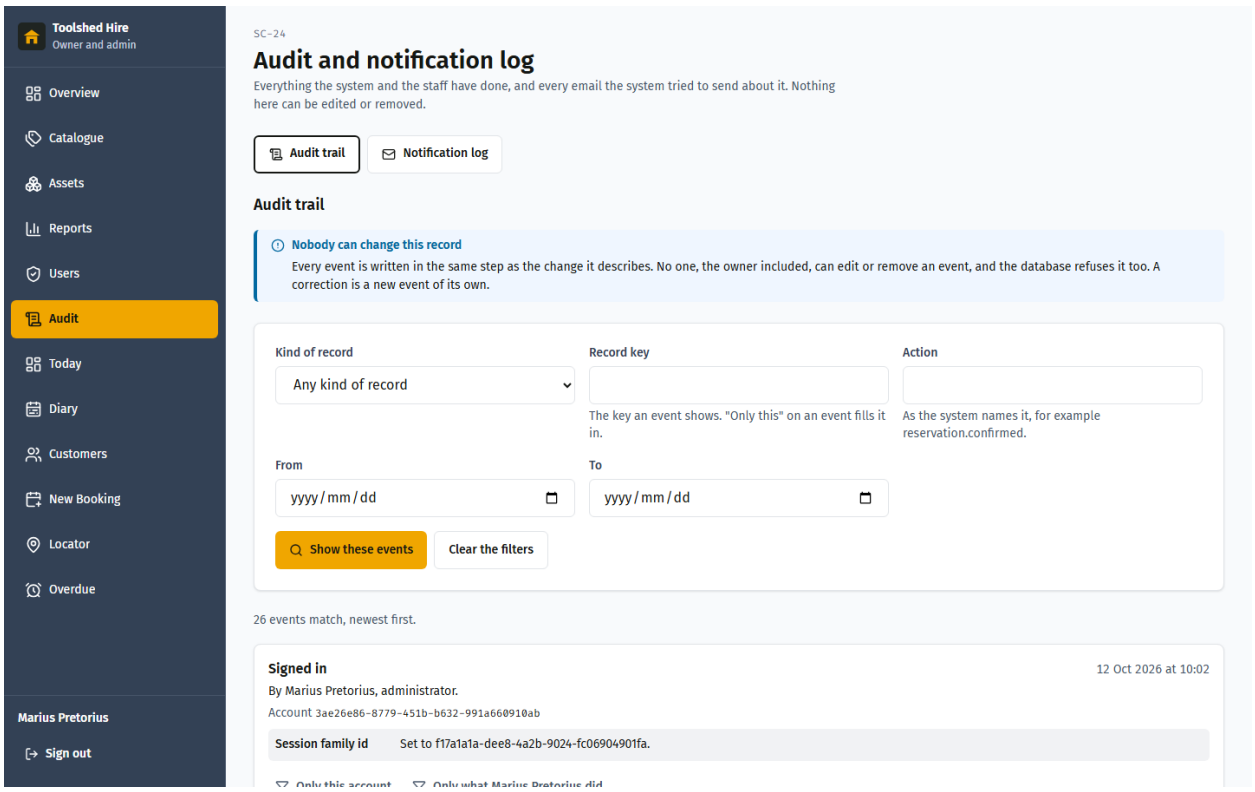


Figure 29: SC-24 Audit and Notification Log

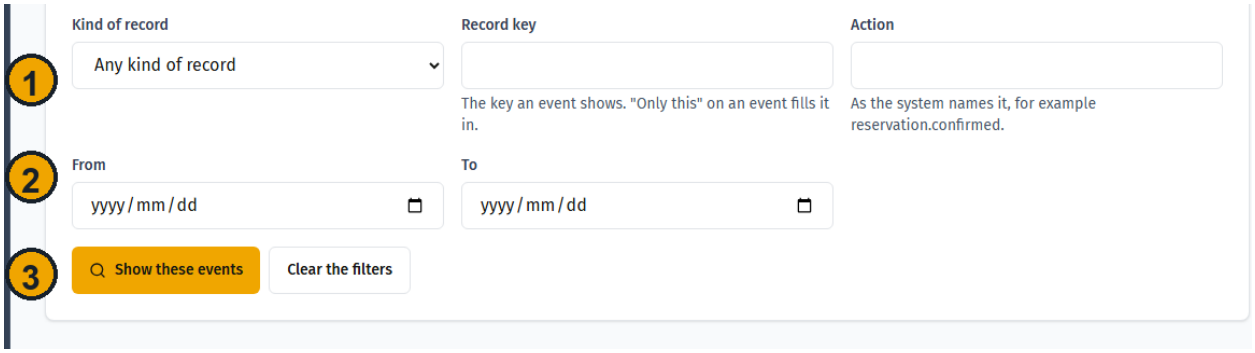


Figure 30: The audit filters on SC-24. 1 the kind of record, 2 the dates, 3 show the events.

6.7 Closure days and public holidays

1. Open the branch settings from the dashboard or the diary.
2. The next twelve months of public holidays are shown read-only. They are worked out from the Public Holidays Act.
3. Add a closure day for one branch or for every branch.
4. The confirm step lists every booking that starts or ends on the new day.
5. The bookings are not cancelled automatically. The owner can telephone the customers.

A closure day is cancelled, never deleted. The cancellation is written to the audit trail.

7. Messages you may meet

The system writes a plain sentence for every refusal. The sentence says what happened and what to do next. The table below covers the messages a user is most likely to meet.

Message	What it means	What to do
The branch has closed for today. The earliest a hire can start is tomorrow.	A booking cannot start after the branch's closing time.	Choose tomorrow or a later open day.
That day is a Sunday, when the branch is closed.	The chosen day is not a trading day.	Choose the next open day shown on the screen.
The day it comes back must be after the day it goes out.	The return day is not later than the collection day.	Choose a later return day.
No unit is free at that branch for those dates.	The branch cannot supply the full quantity for every day.	Try another branch, another model or other dates.
That booking cannot be found.	The reference does not belong to you or does not exist.	Check the reference and sign in to the right account.
Your account is on hold.	Repeated late cancellations or another standing issue.	Speak to the owner or the branch manager.
Your email address is not verified yet.	The account exists but the verification link has not been used.	Open the verification message or ask for a new one.
Too many attempts. Try again later.	The sign-in or registration throttle has been reached.	Wait for the period shown on the screen.
The hold has run out.	The thirty-minute hold expired before confirmation.	Hold the equipment again.
That photograph is not a JPEG or a PNG.	The file's content is not an image the system accepts.	Choose a real JPEG or PNG.
That photograph is larger than 4 MB.	The file exceeds the upload limit.	Reduce the image and try again.
That photograph cannot be read.	The image is corrupt or the upload was interrupted.	Take another photograph or choose another file.
The equipment cannot go out before its collection day.	A future booking was checked out too early.	Check it out on the collection day.
The deposit is not enough to cover the damage.	The recovery is larger than the deposit held.	Record the balance due and follow the damage procedure.
The report period may be 366 days at most.	The owner chose a longer period.	Shorten the period or run two reports.
The CSV is not ready.	The download was requested before the report finished.	Run the report, then download.

8. Troubleshooting and questions

8.1 The first page is slow

The first request after a quiet period may wake the database and the API. Later requests are faster. If the site is slow for more than a minute, check the status page or try again. The counter should use the diary or the locator rather than reloading the catalogue in a loop.

8.2 I was signed out unexpectedly

The access token lasts fifteen minutes and is renewed by a refresh cookie. A browser that blocks cookies, a private window that is closed, or a long period away can end the session. Sign in again. A refresh token that is reused after it has been rotated is refused, and the account is signed out on purpose.

8.3 The confirmation email did not arrive

On the demonstration site, email is restricted to one address. The confirmation screen always shows the booking reference. If the email does not arrive, use the reference on the screen. Counter staff can re-send the confirmation, but the same restriction applies.

8.4 The branch is not open

The branch trades on weekdays from 07:00 to 17:00 and on Saturdays from 07:00 to 13:00. It is closed on Sundays and public holidays. A closure day may also be set by the owner. The booking screen shows the next open day.

8.5 A unit is not offered

The unit may be out on hire, quarantined, under repair, lost or retired. The locator shows the state and the branch. A unit that is free in the fleet may still be taken for overlapping dates. The search only offers a unit when it is free for every day of the period.

8.6 I cannot find a customer

Search by part of the name, the phone number or the email address. A walk-in customer has no login, so search by the name or phone number used at registration. The search needs at least two characters.

8.7 The report is slow

A full year at the demonstration volume can take longer than a month. Run the report for the period you need, not for every year at once. The CSV is generated after the report is in memory, so wait for the report before downloading.

8.8 I need a copy of my data

Sign in and open **Account**. Choose the period and download the statement as a CSV or print it to PDF. Choose **Download all my data** for the JSON export. The export is the personal data the system holds about you.

8.9 A photograph will not upload

The file must be a JPEG or a PNG and no larger than 4 MB. The system reads the file's content, not its name. A screenshot saved as a different format is refused. Take the photograph again or export it as a JPEG.

8.10 The page looks different on my phone

The customer screens adapt to a phone, with a bottom navigation bar. The counter and owner screens are designed for a wider screen. Rotate the phone or use a tablet or laptop for counter work.

8.11 How do I stop using the site?

Close the tab. The basket is kept only in that tab and is cleared when the tab closes. A confirmed booking remains on your account until you cancel it. A hold expires after thirty minutes.

9. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Allocation	The link between a booking line and one physical unit for a date range. The exclusion constraint stops two allocations overlapping for the same unit.
Booking	A customer's reservation, from draft to confirmed, collected, returned or cancelled. The screen calls it a booking. The database calls it a reservation.
Closure day	A day the owner has closed one branch or every branch. It is cancelled, never deleted.
Deposit	The amount held when equipment goes out. It is returned after the equipment comes back, less any late fee, damage recovery or loss.
Gross contribution	Hire revenue plus late fees plus damage recovery, less repair costs. A deposit is not revenue.
Hire	The period a unit is out, from checkout to return. A hire has one or more rental items.
Hold	A thirty-minute reservation of the units while the customer confirms. It is not a confirmed booking.
Quarantine	A unit state for a unit that is out of service because of damage.
Serviceable day	A day the unit was in the fleet and not out of service.
Settlement	The deposit calculation at return.
Utilisation	The share of serviceable days a unit was on hire or booked.

10. For the technical reader

The system is a React front end on Vercel, a FastAPI service on Google Cloud Run in London and a PostgreSQL database on Neon in London. The browser talks to one origin, /api, and Vercel forwards that path to Cloud Run. The database is reached over TLS with a restricted application role. Migrations run as a separate role.

The repository is <https://github.com/teon-artilionAI/toolshed-hire>. The README has the local setup, the route table, the environment variables and the test commands. The short version is:

1. Start the local PostgreSQL container with docker compose up -d --wait.
2. Set DATABASE_URL to the local database.
3. Run alembic upgrade head and python seed.py in backend.
4. Start the API with uvicorn app.main:app --reload --port 8000.
5. Start the front end with npm run dev in frontend.

The seed creates three branches, about 120 models, about 400 assets, two customers, three staff accounts and a season of trading history. The seed password is a development password and is never used in production. The browser tests run against a production build served by Vite preview, with the same security headers as Vercel.

The deployment path is a pull request into develop, both required checks, a staging deploy with migrations, seed, smoke tests and role journeys, then a release branch, a tag, approval and a candidate revision. The candidate is smoke tested before it takes production traffic. A rollback shifts traffic to the previous ready revision. The operations notes and the incident procedure are kept with the project documentation.

The system is a demonstration for a university module. It is not a real hire business and it does not take card payments. The production site is kept running until the marks are released.